

CRIME INVESTIGATION - EVIDENCE REPORT

Case Reference: MYS-2026-MR-0102

Prepared by: Forensic Team: Dr. Meghana Bhat, Inspector Shivaraj Gowda

Date: Evidence Logged: 10 June 2026, 03:00 PM

1. Physical Evidence

Item E-001: Two spent 32 bore cartridge cases from the study floor; ballistics indicate they match the victim's missing revolver. Item E-002: Partial fingerprint lifted from the study safe keypad, sent for comparison. Item E-003: A cigar stub of a premium brand near the study door; DNA sample collected, victim did not smoke. Item E-004: Tyre impressions of a large SUV at the farmhouse gate. Item E-005: Poison residue in the dog's bowl, consistent with a common rat poison, indicating premeditation.

2. CCTV and Digital Evidence

Gate CCTV shows the victim's car arriving at 9:45 PM. A white Toyota Innova arrives at 10:20 PM and leaves at 11:35 PM; partial plate KA-09-M visible. Only one occupant is clearly visible entering the farmhouse, a heavy-set man in a dark shirt. Tower data places two mobile phones near the farmhouse between 10:15 PM and 11:40 PM, one of which was switched on only that evening and has not been used since.

3. Witness Statements

Basavaiah (Caretaker): Away at the wedding in Hassan, confirmed by over 200 guests and videographer footage. Says only he and the victim knew the safe code, apart from the victim's long-time partner from earlier years. A neighbouring farmer, Chikkanna, saw a white Innova on the farm road around 10:15 PM and remembers the driver was talking angrily on a phone. Shalini Hegde states her husband received a call around 9:30 PM and left in a hurry.

4. Financial Evidence

Bank records show Rs. 4 lakh in cash deposited to an account of Manjunath Naik two days after the murder. Ravi Gowda withdrew Rs. 5 lakh in cash a week before the murder. Karthik Hegde owed roughly Rs. 18 lakh to an online betting operator.